

Haochen Ni

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Education

University College London

Sep 2024 – June 2027

BSc Economics – Predicted First Class Honours

Relevant Modules: Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Advanced Econometrics, Game Theory, Information Economics, Advanced Linear Algebra, Real Analysis, Optimisation

A-levels: 3 A* (Maths, Economics, Further Maths).

Sep 2022 – June 2024

Research Interests: Microeconomic Theory, Game Theory, Information Economics, Industrial Organisation

Research Experience and Academic Projects

Independent Research Project in Progress

(London, UK) May 2026 – Present

Kantian Belief and Collective Pivotality in Threshold Public Good Games

- Developed a threshold public-good contribution theory in which an agent's own contribution is informative about the likely contribution behaviour of like-minded agents, generating a belief-based notion of collective pivotality.
- Defined the conditional collective-pivotality premium, measuring how much contribution reasoning increases the perceived probability that the public-good threshold is reached.
- Derived a decisive-interval result showing that collective pivotality is non-monotone in perceived like-minded support: too little support discourages contribution, while too much support makes contribution redundant.
- Analysed comparative statics and a dynamic extension showing how belief updates affect contribution incentives.

Research Assistant

(Imperial College London, London, UK) June 2026 – Present

- Assisted an empirical industrial organisation project on Chinese pharmaceutical markets, focusing on how volume-based procurement may affect firm incentives and substitution patterns across drug categories.
- Constructed a preliminary Yaodu-Cortellis company-matching workflow using name standardisation, token-based candidate generation, fuzzy matching, local LLM/API-assisted screening, and manual auditing.
- Reviewed literature on pharmaceutical pricing and Chinese patent medicines, developing a proposal on whether procurement pressure on chemical drugs induces substitution toward Chinese patent medicines.

Independent Research Project

(UCL, London, UK) March 2026 – May 2026

A Structural Theory of the Willingness-to-Pay Gap: Valuation and Behaviour in Climate Mitigation

- Developed a micro-founded model distinguishing stated WTP as a welfare-based compensating variation object from actual contribution as an optimisation-based behavioural choice.
- Showed that a value-action wedge can arise under rational behaviour because welfare valuation and contribution behaviour are governed by different economic conditions.
- Analysed how altruism, warm-glow, social image, and observability affect the size of the wedge, deriving comparative-static implications for when visibility narrows the gap.
- Shortlisted for UCL Explore Econ 2026 and selected for presentation.

Coursework Project

(UCL, London, UK) Feb 2025 – Mar 2025

- Conducted an empirical study of the relationship between Japan's gender ratio and income inequality using annual time-series data from 1990 to 2022.
- Estimated a quadratic regression model using Stata and Excel, with the Gini coefficient as the dependent variable, controlling for labour participation and log population.
- Interpreted the nonlinear relationship in relation to Japan's labour-market structure and "Womenomics" reforms.

Academic Engagement

- Attended UCL Centre for Theoretical and Behavioural Economics (THEBES) seminars on economic theory, behavioural economics, and experimental economics, with particular interest in models of strategic interactions.

Skills & Interests

Technical Skills: Python, Mathematica, Stata, LaTeX, Excel.

Language: Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent), Japanese (Intermediate).

Societies: UCL Economists' Society, UCL Philosophy Society, UCL Japan Society.